


**Figure 3.1 The consumer sets up request and response in the form of a contract, which gets created within a mock server.**

Being the consumer in contract testing, in our experience, comes with its challenges as the driving force for the whole contract testing process. You have to be able to persuade the other teams to buy into the process. As the consumer, you can create the contract and publish it to the contract broker, but often, you depend on multiple teams to benefit from contract testing. In summary, a consumer is a service user that requests data from a service and is the driving force of contract testing.

## 3.2 What is a provider?

A *provider* is a "person or thing that provides" (https://mng.bz/NBaD). Using our retail consumer analogy from the previous section, an example of a provider is the energy supplier that provides the energy to power the fridge. The energy provider must be compatible with all the different types of consumer products, even though each product may have a different power usage or even different sockets.

On the other side of the request is a service collating and returning the relevant data. The provider, as described, "provides" some data to consumers. As shown in figure 3.2, the provider runs the consumer request against their local service and verifies the response.